

2023-11-19

Re: Submission of manuscript for consideration by Ornithological Applications

Dear Editor:

We respectfully submit the enclosed manuscript "*Peregrine Falcon re-establishment in central California reduces Prairie Falcon occupancy, but not per capita reproduction*" for consideration by Ornithological Applications. The manuscript presents a careful analysis of 15 years of data from a U.S. National Park to better understand the effects of the Peregrine Falcon reintroduction on Prairie Falcon occupancy and reproduction as the system transitioned from two raptors to a single raptor and is now again a two-raptor system. Additionally, the manuscript joins occupancy modeling with recent techniques from causal inference to help determine the most important covariates affecting Prairie Falcon occupancy and reproduction in the face of changing climate and the reintroduced competitor. The findings will help guide conservation managers in other systems where Peregrine falcons are re-establishing themselves after a long absence and provides a robust example of causal inference from long-term ornithological data.

Thank you for your consideration,

Ben Becker, Ph.D.
Californian Cooperative Ecosystem Studies Unit
National Park Service and UC Berkeley

bbecker@berkeley.edu